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INTERNATIONAL DIPLOMATIC COUNCIL OF TAMIL EELAM

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Barbaric attack against elected representative and Lt. Col. Thileepan commemoration vehicle

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IDCTE vehemently condemns the barbaric attack by Sinhalese mobs against a vehicle that was parading for the 36th commemoration of Lt. Col. Thileepan in Tamileelam. Organized by the Tamil National People's Front commemorative vehicle carrying the memory and picture of Lt. Col. Thileepan started to drive from Poththuvil to Nallur where the hunger strike of Thileepan took place in 1987.

During the journey a group of Sinhalese mobs started to attack both the vehicle and the Tamil activists in the scene, including MP Selvarajah Kajendran using stones and batons. Result of this the vehicle was damaged and activists were injured.

Sri Lanka has a record of denying the fundamental right of remembering our loved ones who have sacrificed their lives for the prosperity and sovereignty of Tamileelam. Lt. Col. Thileepan was a 23 years old student activist who peacefully sacrificed his life in a hunger strike in 1987 with his five demands for the people of Tamil nation.

This barbaric attack was followed up by an attack on MP Selvarajah Kajendran despite the presence of police. The police's inaction to prevent this attack shows that even elected representatives are not in safe in the Sinhalese-Buddhist nationalism state.

We immediately urge members of the International Community to strongly condemn this barbaric and unlawful attacks against a peaceful commemoration and elected representatives.